

DECODER

1-9

MASTER SPECIAL POINTS DECODER

Every Special-Point Category, Cumulative, Tiered A/B/C

Five Shu · Yuan · Luo · Back-Shu · Front-Mu · Xi-Cleft · He-Sea · Confluent · Command · Hui-Meeting

TIER A

*Dr. Zhang's confirmed final-exam review
emphasis -- know cold*

TIER B

*Quiz-tested (Quiz 1-6) and/or high
clinical yield -- know well*

TIER C

*Classical/reference material -- lower
priority per Dr. Zhang's Week 9
statement*

This is NOT the weekly Study Guide -- it is organized BY POINT CATEGORY, not by channel.

Use it to cross-check: "what are ALL the Yuan-Source points?" instead of "what is LU's Yuan-Source?"

Every category is cross-referenced back to the per-channel ID cards in the Final Study Guide.

SPECIAL POINT CATEGORY DEFINITIONS

Read this page FIRST -- every table after assumes you know these terms

Five Shu (Transport) Points	A set of 5 points on each of the 12 primary meridians, located distal to the elbows/knees, through which Qi is said to flow like water: Jing-Well (emerges) -> Ying-Spring (flows) -> Shu-Stream (pours) -> Jing-River (travels) -> He-Sea (enters). Each stage has a distinct clinical application (first aid, febrile disease, joint pain, externally-contracted disease, and Fu-organ disorders, respectively).
Yuan-Source Point	The point where a channel's "Source Qi" (Yuan Qi) is most concentrated and accessible -- effectively the primary tonification/regulation point for that channel's associated organ. On Yin channels it coincides with the Shu-Stream point; on Yang channels it is a separate 6th point.
Luo-Connecting (Luo) Point	The point where a small branch ("Luo-vessel") splits off from the main channel and runs to its internally-externally paired channel, physically linking the two. Used to treat either channel from one point, and clinically significant for chronic/deficiency patterns of the paired organ.
Back-Shu (Transport) Point	One of 12 points on the Bladder channel's inner back line, each directly overlying/associated with a specific Zang-Fu organ. Back-Shu points are the most direct route to influence an organ's Qi from the body's posterior surface -- used heavily in both diagnosis (palpation tenderness) and treatment.
Front-Mu (Alarm) Point	A point on the chest or abdomen, on the front of the body, most closely associated with a specific Zang-Fu organ -- often located near that organ's physical location. Front-Mu points are especially useful for ACUTE organ disorders and, like Back-Shu points, are diagnostically tender on palpation.
Xi-Cleft (Accumulation) Point	A point where a channel's Qi and Blood pool or "accumulate" more deeply than usual. The go-to point category for ACUTE, often painful presentations of that channel's pathology -- acute pain, acute bleeding, or acute spasm -- distinct from the more chronic focus of He-Sea points.
He-Sea (Uniting) Point	The point nearest the elbow or knee where a channel's Qi is said to converge/"enter" most fully, like a river reaching the sea. Classically used for disorders of the Six Fu (hollow) organs and for rebellious/reversed Qi (e.g., vomiting, diarrhea).
Lower He-Sea Point	A special subset of He-Sea points specifically for the 6 Fu organs, located on the leg. Three Fu organs (ST, GB, BL) use their own He-Sea point; the other three (LI, SI, SJ) BORROW a point on a different Foot channel entirely -- a frequently-tested distinction.
Confluent (Opening) Point	One of 8 points on the 12 primary meridians that each "open" (activate) one of the 8 Extraordinary Vessels. Confluent points are the ONLY way to access an Extraordinary Vessel's function through needling, since the vessels themselves (except GV/CV) have no points of their own.
Command Point	One of a small classical set of points (the Four Command Points/Si Zong Xue) each said to "command" -- have outsized therapeutic reach over -- an entire body region (abdomen, back, face/mouth, head/nape), regardless of where the specific complaint is located within that region.
Hui-Meeting (Influential) Point	One of 8 points, each governing a broad tissue/substance category (Qi, Blood, Bone, Marrow, Sinew, Vessels, and the Zang or Fu organs as groups) rather than a single channel or organ -- used when a condition affects that category broadly, cutting across multiple channels.

Crossing (Meeting) Point

A point where two or more channels physically intersect or run together for a stretch. A crossing point can be needed to influence every channel that passes through it, not just the channel it's numbered under -- explaining why some points (e.g. GV14, SP6) show up in multiple channels' pathology.

FIVE SHU (TRANSPORT) POINTS -- 60-POINT MASTER TABLE

TIER A

A specific group of 5 points on each of the 12 primary meridians, situated distal to the elbows/knees: Jing-Well (“where it emerges”, tips of fingers/toes, first aid/resuscitation), Ying-Spring (“where it flows”, before MCP/MTP, febrile disease), Shu-Stream (“where it pours”, after MCP/MTP, heaviness & joint pain), Jing-River (“where it travels”, forearm/lower leg, externally-contracted disease), He-Sea (“where it enters”, near elbow/knee, disorders of the six Fu).

Meridian	Jing-Well	Ying-Spring	Shu-Stream	Jing-River	He-Sea
Lung (LU)	LU11 Shaoshang	LU10 Yuji	LU9 Taiyuan	LU8 Jingqu	LU5 Chize
Large Intestine (LI)	LI1 Shangyang	LI2 Erjian	LI3 Sanjian	LI5 Yangxi	LI11 Quchi
Stomach (ST)	ST45 Lidui	ST44 Neiting	ST43 Xianggu	ST41 Jiexi	ST36 Zusanli
Spleen (SP)	SP1 Yinbai	SP2 Dadu	SP3 Taibai	SP5 Shangqiu	SP9 Yinlingquan
Heart (HT)	HT9 Shaochong	HT8 Shaofu	HT7 Shenmen	HT4 Lingdao	HT3 Shaohai
Small Intestine (SI)	SI1 Shaoze	SI2 Qianggu	SI3 Houxi	SI5 Yanggu	SI8 Xiaohai
Bladder (BL)	BL67 Zhiyin	BL66 Zutonggu	BL65 Shugu	BL60 Kunlun	BL40 Weizhong
Kidney (KI)	KI1 Yongquan	KI2 Rangu	KI3 Taixi	KI7 Fuli	KI10 Yingu
Pericardium (PC)	PC9 Zhongchong	PC8 Laogong	PC7 Daling	PC5 Jianshi	PC3 Quze
San Jiao (SJ)	SJ1 Guanchong	SJ2 Yemen	SJ3 Zhongzhu	SJ6 Zhigou	SJ10 Tianjing
Gallbladder (GB)	GB44 Zuqiaoyin	GB43 Xiashi	GB41 Zulinqi	GB38 Yangfu	GB34 Yanglingquan
Liver (LR)	LR1 Dadun	LR2 Xingjian	LR3 Taichong	LR4 Zhongfeng	LR8 Ququan

Yin meridians have NO separate Yuan-Source point -- the Shu-Stream point IS the Yuan point (e.g. Taiyuan LU9 is both Shu-Stream and Yuan for Lung; Taixi KI3 for Kidney). Yang meridians have a 6th, separate Yuan-Source point beyond the 5 Shu points (e.g. Chongyang ST42, Hegu LI4).

YUAN-SOURCE POINTS -- ALL 12 MERIDIANS

TIER A

LU	LU9 Taiyuan	BL	BL64 Jinggu
LI	LI4 Hegu -- FORBIDDEN in pregnancy	KI	KI3 Taixi (also Shu-Stream -- dual role)
ST	ST42 Chongyang	PC	PC7 Daling
SP	SP3 Taibai	SJ	SJ4 Yangchi
HT	HT7 Shenmen	GB	GB40 Qiuxu
SI	SI4 Wangu	LR	LR3 Taichong

On YIN channels, the Yuan-Source point IS the Shu-Stream point (dual role, same point). On YANG channels, Yuan-Source is a separate 6th point beyond the 5 Shu points.

LUO-CONNECTING POINTS -- ALL 15

TIER A

Luo Point	Connection	Note
LU7 Lieque	LU -> LI	also opens Ren Mai (Week 7)
LI6 Pianli	LI -> LU	closest pairing around the wrist to LU7
ST40 Fenglong	ST -> SP	#1 phlegm point in TCM
SP4 Gongsun	SP -> ST	also opens Chong Mai
HT5 Tongli	HT -> SI	1 cun above wrist crease
SI7 Zhizheng	SI -> HT	5 cun above wrist
BL58 Feiyang	BL -> KI	7 cun above external malleolus
KI4 Dazhong	KI -> BL	posterior to internal malleolus
PC6 Neiguan	PC -> SJ	also opens Yin Wei Mai
SJ5 Waiguan	SJ -> PC	also opens Yang Wei Mai
GB37 Guangming	GB -> LR	5 cun above external malleolus
LR5 Ligou	LR -> GB	5 cun above internal malleolus
CV15 Jiuwei	Ren Mai collateral	spreads over the FRONT midline/abdomen
GV1 Changqiang	Du Mai collateral	spreads over the BACK midline
SP21 Dabao	Great (Major) Collateral of Spleen	covers the LATERAL chest -- why there are 15, not 12

Connecting (Luo) points of HAND meridians cluster around the WRIST. Connecting points of FOOT meridians cluster around the ANKLE/MALLEOLUS. CV/GV/SP-Great-Luo are the exceptions, covering front midline, back midline, and lateral chest respectively.

BACK-SHU POINTS -- ORGAN TRANSPORT SERIES (BL13-BL28)

TIER A

Point	Organ Treated
BL13 Feishu	Lung
BL14 Jueyinshu	Pericardium
BL15 Xinshu	Heart
BL18 Ganshu	Liver
BL19 Danshu	Gallbladder
BL20 Pishu	Spleen
BL21 Weishu	Stomach
BL22 Sanjiaoshu	San Jiao
BL23 Shenshu	Kidney
BL25 Dachangshu	Large Intestine
BL27 Xiaochangshu	Small Intestine
BL28 Pangguangshu	Bladder

All 12 Back-Shu points sit on the Bladder channel's inner line, 1.5 cun lateral to the spine -- roughly in organ order top-to-bottom. BL20 (Spleen) and BL21 (Stomach) sit directly adjacent and are a classic confusable pair.

FRONT-MU POINTS -- ALL 12 MERIDIANS

TIER A

LU	LU1 Zhongfu (own -- unusual)	BL	CV3 Zhongji
LI	ST25 Tianshu (on ST channel)	KI	GB25 Jingmen
ST	CV12 Zhongwan	PC	CV17 Danzhong
SP	LR13 Zhangmen (on LR channel)	SJ	CV5 Shimen
HT	CV14 Juque	GB	GB24 Riyue (own)
SI	CV4 Guanyuan	LR	LR14 Qimen (own)

Front-Mu points are scattered across several channels (CV, ST, LR, GB) rather than clustered on one channel like Back-Shu -- the classic Front-Mu exam trap is assuming a point sits on its own channel (e.g. ST25 is Front-Mu of LARGE INTESTINE, not Stomach).

XI-CLEFT POINTS -- ALL 12 MERIDIANS

TIER B

LU	LU6 Kongzui	BL	BL63 Jinmen
LI	LI7 Wenliu	KI	KI5 Shuiquan
ST	ST34 Liangqiu	PC	PC4 Ximen
SP	SP8 Diji	SJ	SJ7 Huizong
HT	HT6 Yinxi	GB	GB36 Waiqiu
SI	SI6 Yanglao	LR	LR6 Zhongdu

Xi-Cleft points are the go-to for ACUTE presentations of that channel's pathology (acute pain, acute bleeding, acute spasm) -- contrast with He-Sea points, used more for chronic/Fu-organ disorders.

HE-SEA POINTS -- ALL 12 MERIDIANS

TIER B

LU	LU5 Chize	BL	BL40 Weizhong (Command, back)
LI	LI11 Quchi	KI	KI10 Yingu
ST	ST36 Zusanli	PC	PC3 Quze
SP	SP9 Yinlingquan	SJ	SJ10 Tianjing
HT	HT3 Shaohai	GB	GB34 Yanglingquan (also Hui-Meeting Sinews)
SI	SI8 Xiaohai	LR	LR8 Ququan

LOWER HE-SEA POINTS -- THE 6 FU ORGANS

TIER B

Point	Fu Organ	Use
ST37 Shangjuxu	Large Intestine	LI bowel disorders (diarrhea, appendicitis-type pain)
ST39 Xiajuxu	Small Intestine	SI bowel disorders, lower abdominal pain
BL39 Weiyang	San Jiao	water metabolism, edema, lower back/leg pain
ST36 Zusanli	Stomach (own)	master tonic, digestion, immunity
GB34 Yanglingquan	Gallbladder (own)	also Hui-Meeting of Sinews -- tendons, hypochondriac pain
BL40 Weizhong	Bladder (own)	also Command Point of the back

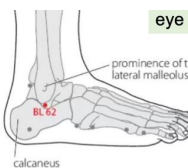
The 6 Fu (hollow) organs each have a Lower He-Sea point on the leg. ST, GB, and BL simply use their own He-Sea point (already Fu channels). LI, SI, and SJ -- despite being Hand channels -- BORROW a Lower He-Sea point on a FOOT channel (ST or BL) instead of using a point on their own pathway. This is a classic exam trap: LI's and SI's Lower He-Sea points are NOT on the LI or SI channel at all.

EIGHT CONFLUENT POINTS -- OPEN THE 8 EXTRAORDINARY VESSELS

TIER A



Spine pain, fever



SI3 Houxi + BL62 Shenmai

Opens: Du Mai + Yang Qiao Mai

Use: posterior body, spine, neck, febrile disease



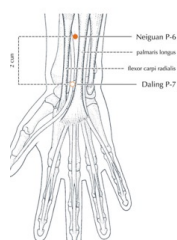
LU7 Lieque + KI6 Zhaohai

Opens: Ren Mai + Yin Qiao Mai

Use: throat, chest, lung, insomnia



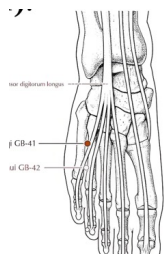
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SP4 Gongsun + PC6 Neiguan

Opens: Chong Mai + Yin Wei Mai

Use: chest, heart, stomach -- MOST-used pairing in clinic



GB41 Zulinqi + SJ5 Waiguan

Opens: Dai Mai + Yang Wei Mai

Use: lateral body, hypochondriac pain, exterior disorders

FOUR COMMAND POINTS (SI ZONG XUE)

TIER B

Point	Governs Region	Note
ST36 Zusanli	Abdomen	the #1 tonic point in TCM; He-Sea + Lower He-Sea of ST
BL40 Weizhong	Back	He-Sea of BL; "aspirin of acupuncture"
LU7 Lieque	Head / Nape	Luo of LU; also Confluent point opening Ren Mai
LI4 Hegu	Face / Mouth	Yuan-Source of LI; FORBIDDEN in pregnancy

The Four Command Points (Si Zong Xue) -- a classical mnemonic distinct from, but often confused with, the 8 Confluent Points. "Command" points treat a whole body REGION; Confluent points open an Extraordinary Vessel. Some points (LU7, LI4) do double duty as both a Command point AND part of another special category -- always check whether a question is asking about regional command or vessel confluence.

EIGHT HUI-MEETING (INFLUENTIAL) POINTS

TIER C

Point	Governs	Use
CV12 Zhongwan	Fu (Hollow) Organs	digestive disorders, all six Fu organs
LR13 Zhangmen	Zang (Solid) Organs	organ-level disharmony, hypochondriac pain
CV17 Danzhong	Qi	chest Qi stagnation, breathing, lactation
BL17 Geshu	Blood	all blood disorders -- bleeding, stasis, deficiency
BL11 Dazhu	Bone	bone disorders, also a classic exterior-releasing point
GB39 Xuanzhong (Juegu)	Marrow	marrow, brain, spinal cord, also relates to bone marrow
GB34 Yanglingquan	Sinew (Tendon)	tendons/ligaments, also He-Sea of GB and Lower He-Sea of GB
LU9 Taiyuan	Vessels (Pulse)	all pulse/vessel disorders, also Yuan-Source of LU

The 8 Hui-Meeting (Influential) Points are classical CAM/MOA reference material -- each governs a tissue/substance category rather than a single channel. Not explicitly confirmed as part of Dr. Zhang's live review, but standard course-textbook material worth recognizing (Tier C).

CROSSING (MEETING) POINTS -- BY CHANNEL

TIER C

Channel	Count	Note
ST	11	the MOST of any single primary channel -- LI20, BL1, GB3/4/6, SP1, GV24, GV26, CV12/13/24
BL	14	shared specifically with GV and Gallbladder, concentrated around the head
GB	12	across 6 meridians (SJ, LR, PC, SI, ST, GV) -- confirmed against the 2026 slide deck
SJ	10+	shares crossing points with GB around head/ear/shoulder, plus GV14, SI12
SP	6	abdomen/chest region -- CV3, CV4, CV10, GB24, LR14, LU1
LR	6	shared with CV (2) and SP (1) around the genital/abdomen region
SI / LI	few	crosses GV14 and the cheek/eye/shoulder region
HT / PC	0	the ONLY 2 primary channels with ZERO named crossing points -- classic paired trap

Per Dr. Zhang's Week 9 review, deep crossing-point memorization is lower priority than the pathway and special-point material above -- know the notable counts (ST=11 most, HT/PC=0) rather than every individual crossing point.

CROSS-REFERENCE INDEX -- ONE ROW PER CHANNEL

Every category, side by side -- the fastest lookup in this document

Ch	Yuan	Luo	Xi-Cleft	He-Sea	Back-Shu	Front-Mu	Confluent/Cmd
LU	LU9 Taiyuan	LU7 Lieque	LU6 Kongzui	LU5 Chize	BL13 Feishu	LU1 Zhongfu (own -- unusual)	LU7 -- opens Ren Mai (paired w/ K16)
LI	LI4 Hegu -- FORBIDDEN in pregnancy	LI6 Pianli	LI7 Wenliu	LI11 Quchi	BL25 Dachangshu	ST25 Tianshu (on ST channel)	LI4 -- face/mouth
ST	ST42 Chongyang	ST40 Fenglong	ST34 Liangqiu	ST36 Zusanli	BL21 Weishu	CV12 Zhongwan	ST36 -- abdomen; Lower He-Sea ST37 (LI) / ST
SP	SP3 Taibai	SP4 Gongsun	SP8 Diji	SP9 Yinlingquan	BL20 Pishu	LR13 Zhangmen (on LR channel)	SP4 -- opens Chong Mai (paired w/ PC6)
HT	HT7 Shenmen	HT5 Tongli	HT6 Yinxi	HT3 Shaohai	BL15 Xinshu	CV14 Jueque	none
SI	SI4 Wangu	SI7 Zhizheng	SI6 Yanglao	SI8 Xiaohai	BL27 Xiaochangshu	CV4 Guanyuan	SI3 Houxi -- opens Du Mai (paired w/ BL62)
BL	BL64 Jinggu	BL58 Feiyang	BL63 Jinmen	BL40 Weizhong (Command, back)	BL28 Pangguangshu (own)	CV3 Zhongji	BL62 Shenmai -- opens Yang Qiao Mai (paired)
KI	KI3 Taixi (also Shu-Stream -- dual role)	KI4 Dazhong	KI5 Shuiquan	KI10 Yingu	BL23 Shenshu	GB25 Jingmen	KI6 Zhaohai -- opens Yin Qiao Mai (paired w/
PC	PC7 Daling	PC6 Neiguan	PC4 Ximen	PC3 Quze	BL14 Jueyinshu	CV17 Danzhong	PC6 -- opens Yin Wei Mai (paired w/ SP4)
SJ	SJ4 Yangchi	SJ5 Waiguan	SJ7 Huizong	SJ10 Tianjing	BL22 Sanjiaoshu	CV5 Shimen	SJ5 -- opens Yang Wei Mai (paired w/ GB41)
GB	GB40 Qixu	GB37 Guangming	GB36 Waiqiu	GB34 Yanglingquan (also Hui-Meeting Sinews)	BL19 Danshu	GB24 Riyue (own)	GB41 Zulinqi -- opens Dai Mai (paired w/ SJ5)
LR	LR3 Taichong	LR5 Ligou	LR6 Zhongdu	LR8 Ququan	BL18 Ganshu	LR14 Qimen (own)	none directly (LR13 is the SP Front-Mu; LR14